



HONG KONG SHANGHAI BANK

In the central business district of Hong Kong stands the impressive Hong Kong Shanghai Bank. This masterpiece of technological engineering was completed in 1985. At every stage of its construction, experts in *feng shui*, the ancient Chinese belief in the natural forces of wind and water, were consulted to ensure that the building would bring health, prosperity, and good fortune to its many occupants.

HONG KONG

Tucked into a corner of southeast China, Hong Kong occupies only a small area, yet almost 6 million people live squashed on its rocky islands and mountainous mainland. It is one of the world's most important financial centers and has one of its most prosperous economies. In 1898, the New Territories of Hong Kong were leased by China to Britain for 99 years. On July 1, 1997, Britain returned the whole of Hong Kong to China.



FLOATING HOMES

Many people in Hong Kong live not on the land but on boats. Families are squashed on to wooden junks and sampans, mostly making their living by fishing. Floating schools, shops, and restaurants serve their needs, while doctors, dentists, and hairdressers do their rounds by boat. Thousands of people still live in these floating villages, but, increasingly, deep-sea trawlers are replacing the traditional boats and forcing the fisherfolk to look for work on land.



HAPPY VALLEY

Surrounded by the towering skyscrapers of Hong Kong, the Happy Valley racecourse is one of Hong Kong's most famous landmarks. Betting money on horse races is hugely popular and is the only legal form of gambling allowed. A season's takings at the race course can amount to over US\$11 billion



TEXTILES

For over one hundred years Hong Kong has had a flourishing textiles industry, exporting its products all over the world. Across Hong Kong, thousands of people are still employed in workshops making T-shirts, suits, and shirts, although there is now fierce competition from countries such as India.

TECHNOLOGY

As traditional industries have declined, Hong Kong's economy has diversified into producing high-tech products such as computers, digital cameras, watches, and cell phones.



digital camera

MACAO

Overshadowed by Hong Kong, its richer and bigger neighbor, Macao consists of a mainland and two islands linked by a bridge and causeway. Macao was returned to China in 1999. When its Portuguese rulers gave up power – after almost 450 years – it was the end of the longest surviving European colony in Asia.



INDUSTRY

Macao produces a variety of goods for export, ranging from textiles and electronic goods to fireworks (shown above) and toys. Every day, low-paid workers from mainland China come to work in the many factories of Macao.



TOURISM

Macao's skyline is dominated by casinos and hotels. The casinos are a big tourist attraction because gambling is very popular with the Chinese and casinos are outlawed in Hong Kong and China. Gambling is a major industry in Macao and provides about one-third of the territory's income.

Find out more

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